

A WORKBOOK

Should I Stay or Leave My Partner?

*The workbook to help you decide
without regrets.*

UNDERSTANDYOURPARTNER

Before you start.

This is a workbook. Not a book. You will write more than you read.

Three rules:

1. Take an evening. Don't rush.
 2. Be honest. No one will read this but you.
 3. There are no right answers. Only true ones.
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By the end of this workbook, you will know what you want to do.

*You may not be ready to do it yet. That is fine.
But you will know.*

How to use this.

Read each page. Write your answer. Move to the next page.

Some rules:

1. Use a pen. Not your phone.
2. Don't go back. Forward only.
3. If you can't answer, write "I don't know" and move on.
4. Be honest. Especially when it hurts.

Time needed: **60 to 90 minutes.**

Take more if you need it. Don't take less.

When in doubt, just write what comes first.

SECTION ONE

What you already know.

The hard part is not finding the answer.

The hard part is letting yourself see what you already know.

Most people who doubt their relationship already know.

The doubt is not "I don't know."

The doubt is "I know, and I am scared."

This section helps you say what you already know. Out loud. On paper. Today.

3 QUESTIONS · ~15 MINUTES

QUESTION 1

If a friend you trust asked you about your relationship right now — in one sentence — what would you tell them?

Write the sentence. The first one that comes. Don't edit it.

QUESTION 2

What is the one thing about your partner you don't tell other people?

Why don't you tell them?

QUESTION 3

Imagine 10 more years with this person. Same as today. No big change.

What is the first feeling that comes up? What is the second one?

SECTION TWO

What's wrong, what's right.

Section 1 was about what you feel.

This one is about what you see.

Feelings can lie in two directions.

When things are bad, you forget the good.

When things are good again, you forget the bad.

This section makes you write both. Side by side. On the same page.

4 QUESTIONS · ~15 MINUTES

THE TWO LISTS

Five things that are wrong. Five things that are right.

One word or short phrase. Not full sentences. Be honest.
Could not fill all five? Leave it blank. The blank tells you something.

WRONG

- 1. _____
- 2. _____
- 3. _____
- 4. _____
- 5. _____

RIGHT

- 1. _____
- 2. _____
- 3. _____
- 4. _____
- 5. _____

QUESTION 4

Which list was easier to write?

QUESTION 5

How long has each thing on the WRONG list been happening?

Write next to each one: weeks, months, or years.

QUESTION 6

Has anything on the RIGHT list gotten weaker over time?

Which ones? When did they start to fade?

QUESTION 7

If only the WRONG list got better — would you stay?

Yes or no. Then write why.

SECTION THREE

What you've tried.

The pain is real.

But pain alone is not the full picture.

What matters more is: what have you done about it?

People who stay in the wrong relationship often have not tried much.

People who have tried everything are often ready to leave.

They just don't know it yet.

5 QUESTIONS · ~10 MINUTES

QUESTION 8

What problems have you tried to fix together?

List them. Short.

QUESTION 9

How many times have you had the same conversation about the same thing?

A few times. Many times. Every week. I stopped trying. Pick one or write your own.

QUESTION 10

What happens when you bring it up?

QUESTION 11

What have you tried — alone?

Therapy. Journaling. Distance. Talks with friends. Change in yourself.

QUESTION 12

After all you have tried — what has actually changed?

Or has everything gone back to the same?

SECTION FOUR

Two futures.

You are deciding today.

But you will live with the decision tomorrow. And next year.

This section asks you to look one year ahead. In two versions.

Version A: you stayed.

Version B: you left.

Same six questions for each. Don't dream. Don't catastrophize. Just answer like a real person living a real Tuesday in March.

12 QUESTIONS · ~25 MINUTES · THE LONGEST SECTION

ONE YEAR FROM NOW

I stayed.

Same partner. Same dynamics. With the small changes you can realistically expect.

QUESTION 13

Where do I live?

QUESTION 14

How do I feel when I wake up on a normal Tuesday?

QUESTION 15

What does Sunday night feel like?

ONE YEAR FROM NOW

I stayed.

Continued from the previous page.

QUESTION 16

Am I closer to my friends, or further?

QUESTION 17

What did I give up to make this work?

QUESTION 18

What is still wrong — that is wrong today?

ONE YEAR FROM NOW

I left.

I went through the breakup. The first months were hard. Twelve months have passed.

QUESTION 19

Where do I live?

QUESTION 20

How do I feel when I wake up on a normal Tuesday?

QUESTION 21

What does Sunday night feel like?

ONE YEAR FROM NOW

I left.

Continued from the previous page.

QUESTION 22

Am I closer to my friends, or further?

QUESTION 23

What do I miss the most?

QUESTION 24

What got better?

SECTION FIVE

Your decision.

You have written for an hour.

You know things now you did not know when you started.

This last section is short.

Three questions. One signature.

The workbook will not tell you what to do.

You will.

3 QUESTIONS · ~5 MINUTES

Look back at every page you have written. Read it slowly. Then answer.

QUESTION 25

In one sentence — what do you actually want to do?

QUESTION 26

What is the one thing that has to be true for you to be at peace with that choice?

QUESTION 27

What is your first step?

One step. Small. Concrete. This week.

*This is my decision today.
I made it. No one made it for me.*

SIGNED

DATE

After you decide.

Sit with it for 48 hours. Don't tell anyone yet.

If on day 3 you feel the same — act on your first step.

If you feel different — read sections 4 and 5 again.

A decision that holds for 72 hours is your decision.

A decision that flips in an hour was not ready.

You did the work. Trust it.

One last thing.

You are not the first person to do this. You will not be the last.

What you did today is rare.

Most people make this choice at 2am, with their gut, after a fight.

You made it with a pen. With time. With your own hand.

| *That is the kind of choice you can live with.*

Whatever you decided — go take your first step.

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